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Thermal module

Abstract

A thermal module includes a fan and a fin assembly. The fan has an air outlet. The fin assembly has multiple fins, and is disposed to the air outlet of the fan. The fins are disposed side by side to form multiple flow channels. Each of the flow channels has a first inlet, at least one second inlet, and an outlet. In each of the flow channels, a gas flow generated by the fan flows into the flow channel from the first inlet and flows out of the flow channel from the outlet, and a gas flow outside the fin assembly is drawn by the gas flow in the flow channel to flow into the flow channel from the at least one second inlet.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATION

(1) This application claims the priority benefit of Taiwan application serial no. 111105522, filed on Feb. 16, 2022. The entirety of the above-mentioned patent application is hereby incorporated by reference herein and made a part of this specification.

BACKGROUND

Technical Field

(2) The disclosure relates to a thermal module.

Description of Related Art

(3) Common electronic devices such as notebook computers, tablet computers, or smart phones have the characteristics of being easy to carry and sending, receiving, and processing information in real time, and have become an indispensable tool for modern people. Taking the notebook computers as an example, in order to satisfy the requirements of users, the thin lightweight design and the improvement of thermal performance have become the mainstream of development. Therefore, the space available for disposing a thermal module inside a body of the notebook computer is gradually reduced.

(4) For example, the thermal module is usually disposed inside the body of the notebook computer, so that a fan of the thermal module and a fin assembly corresponding to the fan may perform active thermal dissipation. In addition, the common fin assembly is formed by multiple fins engaged with one another to form multiple flow channels, so that a gas flow generated by the fan may flow into the fin assembly and perform thermal exchange. However, in the current structural design of the fin assembly, cold air outside the thermal module may not flow into the fin assembly. As a result, the thermal dissipation efficiency of the thermal module may not be effectively improved.

SUMMARY

(5) The disclosure provides a thermal module having good thermal dissipation efficiency.

(6) The thermal module in the disclosure includes a fan and a fin assembly. The fan has an air outlet. The fin assembly has multiple fins, and is disposed to the air outlet of the fan. The fins are disposed side by side to form multiple flow channels. Each of the flow channels has a first inlet, at least one second inlet, and an outlet. In each of the flow channels, a gas flow generated by the fan flows into the flow channel from the first inlet and flows out of the flow channel from the outlet, and a gas flow outside the fin assembly is drawn by the gas flow in the flow channel to flow into the flow channel from the at least one second inlet.

(7) Based on the above, the fin assembly of the thermal module in the disclosure has the fins, and the fins are disposed side by side to form the flow channels. In each of the flow channels, the gas flow generated by the fan is adapted to flow into the flow channel from the first inlet, and the gas flow outside the fin assembly is adapted to be drawn by gas flow in the flow channel to flow into the flow channel from the at least one second inlet. Therefore, in the thermal module in the disclosure, the fin assembly may increase the flow capacity of the gas flow flowing into the fin assembly through the configuration of the at least one second inlet. As a result, the proportion of the gas flow with the relatively low temperature flowing through each of the flow channels is increased, so as to improve the thermal exchange efficiency between the gas flow in each of the flow channels and the fin assembly, so that the thermal module in the disclosure has the good thermal dissipation efficiency.

(8) In order for the aforementioned features and advantages of the disclosure to be more comprehensible, embodiments accompanied with drawings are described in detail below.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) FIG. 1 is a perspective view of a thermal module according to an embodiment of the disclosure.

(2) FIG. 2 is a partial side view of the thermal module of FIG. 1.

(3) FIG. 3A is a perspective view of a fin assembly of FIG. 1.

(4) FIG. 3B is a perspective view of FIG. 3A from another angle of view.

(5) FIG. 4 is a perspective view of a fin of FIG. 3A.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF DISCLOSED EMBODIMENTS

(6) FIG. 1 is a perspective view of a thermal module according to an embodiment of the disclosure.

FIG. 2 is a partial side view of the thermal module of FIG. 1. FIG. 3A is a perspective view of a fin assembly of FIG. 1. FIG. 3B is a perspective view of FIG. 3A from another angle of view. Here, Cartesian coordinates X, Y, and Z are provided to facilitate subsequent descriptions of the components. Referring to FIG. 1 first, a thermal module **100** in this embodiment is, for example, disposed in a casing (not shown) of a notebook computer, so as to discharge heat generated during the operation of electronic elements (not shown) inside the casing (not shown) to an outside. However, the disclosure is not limited thereto.

(7) Referring to FIGS. 1 to 3B, in this embodiment, the thermal module **100** includes a fan **110** and a fin assembly **120**. The fan **110** has an air outlet **111** (FIG. 2), and the fin assembly **120** is disposed to the air outlet **111** of the fan **110**. The fin assembly **120** has multiple fins **121** (FIGS. 3A and 3B), and the fins **121** are disposed side by side to form multiple flow channels **122** (FIGS. 3A and 3B).

(8) In detail, referring to FIG. 2, in this embodiment, each of the flow channels **122** has a first inlet **122a**, two second inlets **122b**, and an outlet **122c**, and the two second inlets **122b** are located between the first inlet **122a** and the outlet **122c** (in a direction parallel to the Y axis). Here, it should be noted that in this embodiment, the first inlet **122a** corresponds to the air outlet **111** of the fan **110**, and the outlet **122c** corresponds to a side of a thermal dissipation hole (not shown) of the casing of the notebook computer. However, the disclosure is not limited thereto.

(9) Therefore, in each of the flow channels **122**, a gas flow F1 generated by the fan **110** is adapted to flow into the flow channel **122** from the first inlet **122a** and flow out of the flow channel **122** from the outlet **122c**. At the same time, a gas flow F2 outside the fin assembly **120** is adapted to be drawn by the gas flow F1 in the flow channel **122** to flow into the flow channel **122** from the two second inlets **122b** and flow out of the flow channel **122** from the outlet **122c**.

(10) It is worth mentioning that in this embodiment, since the gas flow F1 generated by the fan **110** flows into each of the flow channels **122** at a relatively fast flow rate and with a relatively low pressure, the gas flow F2 outside the fin assembly **120** is adapted to be drawn by the gas flow F1 in the flow channel **122** to flow into each of the flow channels **122** from the second inlet **122b**, thereby increasing a flow capacity of the gas flow flowing into the fin assembly **120**. In addition, the fin assembly **120** of the thermal module **100** in this embodiment may allow the gas flow F2 with a relatively low temperature outside the fin assembly **120** to enter each of the flow channels **122** by a configuration of the second inlet **122b** of each of the flow channels **122**, so that a proportion of the gas flow F2 with the relatively low temperature flowing through each of the flow channels **122** may be increased. Therefore, the thermal exchange efficiency between the gas flow F1 and the fin assembly **120** is improved, thereby improving the thermal dissipation efficiency of the thermal module **100**.

(11) Referring to FIG. 2, in this embodiment, the thermal module **100** further includes a heat pipe **130**. The fin assembly **120** has a bearing surface **123**, and the heat pipe **130** is adapted to be in contact with the bearing surface **123** of the fin assembly **120**. The heat pipe **130** is located between the fan **110** and the outlet **122c** of each of the flow channels **122** in the direction parallel to the Y axis, and the bearing surface **123** of the fin assembly **120** is located between the two second inlets **122b** of each of the flow channels **122** in a direction parallel to the Z axis.

(12) In detail, in this embodiment, one of the two second inlets **122b** of each of the flow channels **122** is close to the fan **110** and located below the bearing surface **123** of the fin assembly **120**, and the other of the two second inlets **122b** of each of the flow channels **122** is close to the heat pipe **130** and located above the bearing surface **123** of the fin assembly **120**. In this way, the gas flow F2 with the relatively low temperature outside the fin assembly **120** may enter each of the flow channels **122** respectively from the two second inlets **122b** located above and below the bearing surface **123** of the fin assembly **120**. Therefore, the proportion of the gas flow F2 with the relatively low temperature flowing through each of the flow channels **122** is increased, so as to improve the thermal exchange efficiency between the gas flow F1 and the fin assembly **120**.

(13) In addition, referring to FIG. 2, in this embodiment, an aperture **122-1** of each of the flow

channels **122** gradually expands from the first inlet **122a** to the outlet **122c** along the direction parallel to the Y axis. The two second inlets **122b** of each of the flow channels **122** are respectively located at an incremental position **122-2** of the aperture **122-1** of the flow channel **122**. In this way, the gas flow F1 generated by the fan **110** and the gas flow F2 with the relatively low temperature outside the fin assembly **120** may flow into the flow channel **122** respectively from the first inlet **122a** and the two second inlets **122b**, and smoothly flow out of the flow channel **122** from the outlet **122c**.

(14) Hereinafter, the fins **121** of the fin assembly **120** will be further described.

(15) FIG. **4** is a perspective view of a fin of FIG. **3A**. Referring to FIG. **4**, in this embodiment, each of the fins **121** includes a first side wall **121-1** and two second side walls **121-2**. The first side wall **121-1** has two opposite ends **121-1a** and **121-1b**, and the two second side walls **121-2** are vertically connected to the two ends **121-1a** and **121-1b** of the first side wall **121-1**, respectively. Here, it should be noted that in this embodiment, a structure of each of the fins **121** is, for example, a U-shaped structure formed by folding a sheet metal part, but the disclosure is not limited thereto.

(16) In detail, in this embodiment, each of the fins **121** includes two tongue pieces **121-3**. The two second side walls **121-2** respectively have two notches **121-2a**, and the two tongue pieces **121-3** respectively protrude from the two notches **121-2a** of the two second side walls **121-2** of the fin **121** and are adjacent to an inner edge **121-2b** of the two second side walls **121-2** of the fin **121**. Each of the second side walls **121-2** forms the second inlet **122b** at the notch **121-2a**, and the two tongue pieces **121-3** are respectively disposed at the two second inlets **122b** (FIG. **2**). In other words, in the fin assembly **120** shown in FIG. **1**, except for the first one (which is the rightmost fin in the figure), the second side walls **121-2** of the rest of the fins **121** may be connected to another adjacent fin **121** to form the flow channels **122**, and the second side wall **121-2** has a continuous structure from the first inlet **122a** to the outlet **122c**, and is discontinuous only at the second inlet **122b**.

(17) In more detail, referring to FIG. **2**, in this embodiment, the tongue piece **121-3** disposed at each of the second inlets **122b** extend toward the outlet **122c** along the direction parallel to the Y axis. An aperture **122b-1** of each of the second inlets **122b** may taper (in the Y-axis direction) toward an inside of the flow channel **122** by a configuration of the tongue pieces **121-3** to form a nozzle structure. Here, it should be noted that in this embodiment, each of the tongue pieces **121-3** is, for example, integrally formed with the fin **121**, but the disclosure is not limited thereto. In addition, in this embodiment, each of the tongue pieces **121-3** forms the nozzle structure by stamping, for example. However, the disclosure is not limited thereto.

(18) Therefore, in this embodiment, each of the second inlets **122b** may guide the gas flow F2 with the relatively low temperature outside the fin assembly **120** into the flow channel **122** by the configuration of the tongue pieces **121-3**, and may prevent the gas flow F1 generated by the fan **110** from flowing back at the second inlet **122b** and flowing out of the flow channel **122** from the second inlet **122b** at the same time. Therefore, it is ensured that the gas flow F2 with the relatively low temperature outside the fin assembly **120** may smoothly enter the flow channel **122**, so as to increase the proportion of the gas flow F2 with the relatively low temperature flowing through each of the flow channels **122**.

(19) Based on the above, the fin assembly of the thermal module in the disclosure has the fins, and the fins are disposed side by side to form the flow channels. In each of the flow channels, the gas flow generated by the fan is adapted to flow into the flow channel from the first inlet, and the gas flow outside the fin assembly is adapted to be drawn by gas flow in the flow channel to flow into the flow channel from the at least one second inlet. Therefore, in the thermal module in the disclosure, the fin assembly may increase the flow capacity of the gas flow flowing into the fin assembly through the configuration of the at least one second inlet. As a result, the proportion of the gas flow with the relatively low temperature flowing through each of the flow channels is increased, so as to improve the thermal exchange efficiency between the gas flow in each of the

flow channels and the fin assembly, so that the thermal module in the disclosure has the good thermal dissipation efficiency.

(20) Although the disclosure has been described with reference to the above embodiments, they are not intended to limit the disclosure. It will be apparent to one of ordinary skill in the art that modifications to the described embodiments may be made without departing from the spirit and the scope of the disclosure. Accordingly, the scope of the disclosure will be defined by the attached claims and their equivalents and not by the above detailed descriptions.

Claims

1. A thermal module, comprising: a fan having an air outlet; a heat pipe; and a fin assembly having a plurality of fins and disposed to the air outlet of the fan, wherein the fins are disposed side by side to form a plurality of flow channels, and each of the flow channels has a first inlet, at least one second inlet, and an outlet, in each of the flow channels, a gas flow generated by the fan flows into the flow channel from the first inlet and flows out of the flow channel from the outlet, and a gas flow outside the fin assembly is drawn by the gas flow in the flow channel to flow into the flow channel from the at least one second inlet, wherein the heat pipe is in contact with a bearing surface of the fin assembly, the heat pipe is located between the fan and the outlet of each of the flow channels, a number of the at least one second inlet of each of the flow channels is two, and the bearing surface of the fin assembly is located between the two second inlets of each of the flow channels.
 2. The thermal module according to claim 1, wherein an aperture of the at least one second inlet tapers toward an inside of the flow channel to form a nozzle structure.
 3. The thermal module according to claim 1, wherein an aperture of each of the flow channels gradually expands from the first inlet to the outlet.
 4. The thermal module according to claim 1, wherein an aperture of each of the flow channels increases from the first inlet to the outlet, and the at least one second inlet is located at an incremental position of the aperture of each of the flow channels.
 5. The thermal module according to claim 1, further comprising at least one tongue piece disposed at the at least one second inlet of each of the flow channels, and the at least one tongue piece protrudes from each of the fins and is adjacent to an inner edge of each of the fins.
 6. The thermal module according to claim 5, wherein the at least one tongue piece is integrally formed with each of the fins.
 7. The thermal module according to claim 1, wherein each of the fins comprises a first side wall and two second side walls, the first side wall has two opposite ends, the two second side walls are vertically connected to the two ends of the first side wall, respectively, and the two second side walls have at least one notch.
 8. The thermal module according to claim 1, wherein one of the two second inlets of each of the flow channels is close to the fan and located below the bearing surface of the fin assembly, and the other of the two second inlets of each of the flow channels is close to the heat pipe and located above the bearing surface of the fin assembly.
 9. The thermal module according to claim 1, wherein the at least one second inlet of each of the flow channels is located between the first inlet and the outlet.
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